

Question 1:

Persona Information

	Role in ecosystem	Unique value
1. Leo: Tech-Focused Father, 35 - senior engineer: Silicon Valley; - hyper busy, minimalist; - innovations, transparency, high quality; - rarely shops, science-led products. <i>! Sales Point: science + tech</i>	- not the buyer, but approval	- tech and logic based filter
2. Mia: Full-time Mom of Twins, 30 - ex marketing manager, wife of tech man; - aesthetics, brand culture, child safety; - loves niche brands & fashion, Scandinavian style - follows parenting influencers. <i>! Sales Point: word-of-mouth + fashion</i>	- primary buyer	- design - loyalty - modern parenting
3. Kris: Eco-influencer, 25 - yoga instructor + wellness content creator; - eco-luxury, single mom, carbon-consciousness; - often barter, features brands, hard to earn her trust. <i>! Sales Point: ecofriendly + brand awareness</i>	- organic promoter - brand promoter	- eco-credibility
4. Emma: graduate student, 23 - Masters in environmental policy, 8 months pregnant; - vegan, minimalistic, sustainability; - intentional shopping, cruelty-free, low-waste mindset. <i>! Sales Point: vegan + eco + ethics</i>	- ethical buyer - might purchase once / one item	- loyalty over time - word-of-mouth - brand advocacy
5. Adam: early childhood educator, 42 - professor at university + preschool educator; - deeply principled, multicultural; - science, child-first design, avoids commercialisation. <i>! Sales Point: child health, growth & development</i>	- professional validation - trusted recommendation	- educational credibility - parental circles

Empathy Maps

1. Leo:

<u>Thinks & feels</u> Programming, engineering sprints and meetings - no time for shopping. He emphasises minimalism and new technologies. He wants the best for his child but refuses to be manipulated by advertising.		
<u>Hears</u> His partner (wife) gives him brief information: "It's good for development", "Non-toxic materials", "Manufactured by ethical standards". Sometimes he hears about new product from podcasts or sources related to medical technology.	Leo: Tech-focused Father of Twins, Engineer, 35	<u>Sees</u> Functionality, quality, clear design, structured & creditable reviews. Most baby products look overly "heavy" or lack real functional depth. He notices scientific references.
<u>Says & does</u> "I will do a little research on that.", "Let me look into this one", and "I trust in your choice". He rarely initiates purchases, but always checks and either approves or rejects them. If a product is not approved for a medical use, it won't make it into the house.		
<u>Pains</u> Low quality, lack of medical society approval, marketing hype, empty words without substance, poor UX, unclear sourcing.	<u>Gains</u> Confidence in the brand. Feels that their child is using a well-designed, safe product that is appropriate for long-term development.	

2. Mia:

<u>Thinks & feels</u> Every choice reflects who she is as a mom. She wants products that are practical but also communicate beauty and care. She avoids crowded shopping centres and shops based on carefully selected recommendations or online.		
<u>Hears</u> Parenting chats, tips from momfluencers on YouTube. Husband's opinion in terms of product medical approval and technologies. Phrases like "This is a must-have for modern moms", "Highest quality on the market", "Approved by scientists".	Mia: Full-time Mom of Twins, 30	<u>Sees</u> Soft earthy colours, high product quality and educational content. Seeking modern items and Scandinavian aesthetics. Keeping an eye on influential bloggers with baby hauls, especially fashionable or highly in demand new products.
<u>Says & does</u> She shares finds in her parenting circle, builds trust in brands over time, and posts authentic reviews on private social feeds. "Dear, I found a new product, could you take a look on that?", "This will be perfect for the season!", "I like the story this brand tells" and "I was looking for this for a long time".		
<u>Pains</u> Low quality, mass product, things that fall apart fast or don't align with her aesthetic, no brand understory,	<u>Gains</u> Satisfaction from discovering something healthy, beautiful, and aligned with her parenting values. Trust in the brand earns her repeat business.	

3. Kris:

<u>Thinks & feels</u>		
Her influencing and reputation is on the line with everything she says and every product she promotes. She needs to feel a real connection before aligning with any company.		
<u>Hears</u> Listens and attends sustainable parenting podcasts and shares product information with other ethical creators. Tends to listen to her loyal community and its recommendations.	Kris: Eco-influencer, Yoga Teacher, Single Mom, 25	<u>Sees</u> Handcrafted, low-impact goods, natural materials. Noticed compostable packaging and natural tones. Scrolls past anything that screams “plastic” or “sponsored.”
<u>Says & does</u>		
Is she is “in”, she promotes with depth and awareness - not just tag and recommendation, but real stories. Phrases like “I have experienced on my own.”, “This is the first baby brand I trust in a while”, “ It is hard for me to express the contribution to parenting this brand does!”.		
<u>Pains</u> Ethical sacrifices in the name of ‘ecology’. Screaming marketing and bought reviews, fake business mission and its self-representing, as well as greenwashing.	<u>Gains</u> A brand that reflects her worldview. The chance to introduce something truly good to her audience without selling out.	

4. Emma:

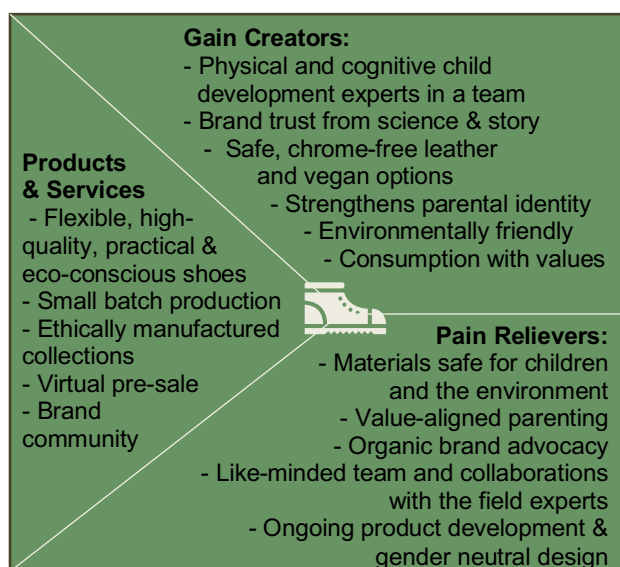
<u>Thinks & feels</u> She's anxious about pregnancy and parenting, but grounded. She wants to raise her child with intention and refuses to sacrifice ethics just because of a limited budget.		
<u>Hears</u> A lot of pregnancy advices - older generations suggest practicality over ethics, but her peers are trying to do both. YouTube videos on the following nurturing and growth of children.	Emma: Graduate Masters Student, Pregnant, 23	<u>Sees</u> Overwhelmed market with different price range. Academic researches and case studies on sustainable design, natural and simple visual materials - not overly fancy baby products.
<u>Says & does</u> She shares product links in peer forums and socials. Participates in slow parenting groups and maintains a registry that reflects her values over convenience. Attends parenting classes.		
<u>Pains</u> Price vs. principles, too many products in the market, lack of medical expertise and academic researches.	<u>Gains</u> Brand that validates her careful choices and proves that ethics and childcare can coexist. Loyalty and brand support over time.	

5. Adam:

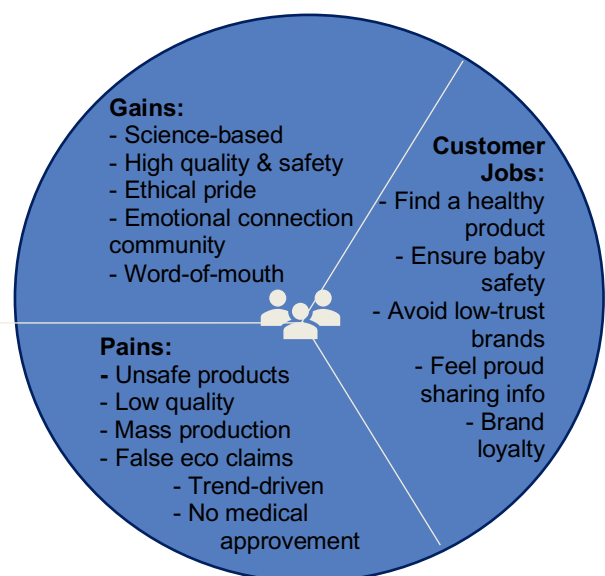
<u>Thinks & feels</u>		
Deep responsibility to protect children's natural development. Gets frustrated when companies sell speed and stimulation over thoughtful growth.		
<u>Hears</u> A lot of parenting questions: "Is this safe?", "Is this good for walking?" and "What should I buy?". Attends and listens field related academical conferences. Audio books and podcasts.	Adam: Professor, Early Childhood Educator, 42	<u>Sees</u> Unknown product origin and potentially dangerous materials. Too many products designed for aesthetics over function. Looks for child-first thinking, not trendiness.
<u>Says & does</u>		
He recommends tools and practices he believes in - at parent's meetings, in teacher trainings and conferences. Sometimes does educational blog. Avoids bias, but speaks up when something works.		
<u>Pains</u> Overdesigned products, lack of academical research and brand medical credibility. Unsupported or fake claims and profit-over-child approaches.	<u>Gains</u> Respects brands that put development before profit. Proud in supporting families with honest, useful advice.	

Value Proposition of Fierce Shoes

Value Proposition



Customer Profile



Conclusions: in the modern market, Fierce Shoes offers more than just children's shoes - it delivers a story, trust, thoughtful design and a genuine idea behind it. The brand's customers choose it because of the safety, high-quality and ethical pride. And the most important thing - Fierce Shoes's product is expert-backed and created by the field experts. It solves a real problem that modern families with different backgrounds and professions face. Overall, with the brand awareness and conscious product approach, word-of-mouth and customer loyalty will work itself.

Question 2:

To reduce criticism of Fierce Shoe's sales system, company can use the RICE matrix to find the most suitable and efficient improvements. It's important that any changes have to match the brand's values - ethical, purpose-driven, thoughtful and customer-friendly.

What They Have vs. What Can Be Improved or Eliminated

What they have:	What can be improved or eliminated:	Why it matters?
Virtual queue	Modern UI/UX: implementing new feature that shows place in the line and estimated wait time.	Builds trust, answers questions in advance, and create a feeling of personalisation and modern customer service approach. Removes uncertainty during high-demand periods
Limited physical sales points	Option 1: Every season attending field-related shows or conferences. Option 2: Seasonal markets and pop-up stands. Option 3: Find & collaborate with small local stores annually.	1. Like-minded and highly target audience. 2. Small-batch, artisan feel and local ethics. Pop-ups are flexible and can be limited or aligned with product drops. 3. Maintains scarcity and control while entering niche local markets. Ethical retail ecosystems.
Return system	Adding extra eco return bag with prepared tracking number to the parcel. Expanded FAQ, improved size-guide and tracking system.	Allows immediate return by placing in the bag and sealing. Reduces return-related anxiety, especially for new buyers. Improves UX and supports first-time conversions.
High Demand / Quick Sell-Outs	Statistical prediction on the in-demand sizes. Surveys and product analytics. Early notifications or loyalty-based personal offers.	Makes demand and product qty feel organised, not chaotic. Rewarding loyal customers and increasing overall customer purchase experience.

Since the case doesn't provide a specific buyer number, only noting that Fierce Shoe sold 1,000 pairs per season in its early days, the RICE matrix above is evaluated using qualitative ratings: High, Medium and Low. In other scenarios, the RICE method could be applied numerically, and to get a RICE score, these factors need to be combined = Reach * Impact * Confidence / Effort = RICE Score

Initiative	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Priority	Justification
Modern UI/UX virtual queue	High	High	High	Medium	High	Current queue feels outdated and creates frustrating user experience. By implementing Modern UI/UX, company builds trust & answers questions in advance.
Seasonal field-related shows or conferences	Medium	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	Some of the customers wants to see and touch the product. Seasonal pop-ups would make the brand feel more real & inclusive.
Modern return system & detailed sizing	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	High	Returns can be risky, messy and hard experience. A modern fit-check guide and easy return system will reduce potential stress and will save a time.
Statistical prediction & Loyalty access	High	High	Medium	Medium	High	Statistical prediction will help to effectively manage production and resources, therefore loyalty-based early access will help to understand approx. order number, as well as keep customer feel special.

Conclusions: the RICE matrix above highlights improvements and how to avoid potential threats. By improving those initiatives, Fierce Shoe can manage current criticism in the best way, and that leads to a balance.

Question 3:

Canvas model for Fierce Shoe

Key Partners	Key Activities	Value Proposition	Customer Relationship	Customer Segments
- Ethical manufacturers in Portugal - Pediatric experts - Child development experts - Material / logistics providers - Crowdfunding platforms and people's support	- Research & development - Sustainable & safe product development (shoes) - Small-batch manufacturing - Product & queue management - Community building & feedback collection	- Science based children's shoes - Designed for natural foot development - Eco & ethical conscious - Gender neutral design - Transparent brand values - Trustability	- Emotional connectional with brand values - Co-creation and feedback-based product evolution - Organic engagement trough storytelling - Loyalty, exclusivity & pre-sale access - Word-of-mouth - Support trough crowdfunding	- Tech & science acknowledge parents - Ethical, minimalist & eco aware parents - Child development educators and professionals - Conscious and gen Z parents - First-time parents: safety & trust in a brand - Parenting modern influencers
	Key Resources - Owner's (Lydia's & partner) design expertise and founder story - Sustainable suppliers, safe & raw materials - Website: virtual queue & digital tools - Loyal customer community		Channels - Fierce Shoe website and pre-sale drops - Word-of-mouth - Crowdfunding platforms + - Influencer's channels: Instagram, Youtube etc. - Seasonal pop-ups - Parenting events	
Cost - Collaboration with field experts & product test - High quality materials - Ethical & sustainable manufacturing			Revenue Streams - Direct shoe sales to customers - Pre-sale opportunity (virtual queue) - Crowdfunding platform +	

- Global logistics operations and packaging expenses - Website & another digital tool maintenance - Community & marketing campaigns - Investments in research + - Pop-ups or local store rent - Influencers barter expenses	- Exclusive product drop for loyal customers (pre-order) - Collaborations with local stores or brands - Limited time or seasonal capsule drop
---	---

Conclusions: As we can see in the Canvas Model above, Fierce Shoe is built on and delivers to its customers safe, science-based and sustainable products for kids. The company's ecosystem is lean but powerful, fuelled by a brand story that resonates personally with field experts and conscious customers. Instead of traditional mass retail, they grow organically through meaningful moments like storytelling, pre-sale and loyalty-based exclusive access. Their cost structure shows a clear priority - field problem (and then Fierce Shoe solution) and its customers over scale or speed.

Question 4:

From the perspective of mindset, values and adaptability - Fierce Shoe is well-suited for the agile methodology.

- The company listens to its customers, creates joint creativity with parents and makes appropriate adjustments to product lines or design.
- Fierce Shoe welcomes changing requirements, especially when demand changes, and it's necessary to respond quickly to a scale of drop or pre-sale.
- Agile values individuality and synergy, that the point where Fierce Shoe thrives on human connections - brand storytelling, word-of-mouth, collaborations with the field experts and potential influencers, and of course, the company's loyal and value-based community.
- Fierce Shoe pace of development is sustainable, and in the modern agile & world in general, it's a very important point. The pace goes without over-scaling expansion or rapid fast-fashion cycles - instead, the brand aligns with agile's principle of maintaining steady, mindful delivery.
- A working product over a comprehensive documentation, as a small team is involved in the product development process. Fierce Shoe product improvements are based on scientific data, testing, and customer feedback.

Fierce Shoe operates in a domain where trust, quality and customer feedback is crucial to maintain the company's success. Agile will empower Fierce Shoe with tools to scale without losing its spirit - implementing light iterations, prioritising backlogs more clearly, and improving internal cross-functionality. As has been mentioned before, Fierce Shoe already has an agile spirit, and to elevate it, agile methodology will help the company develop more effectively in the direction it is already moving.

Question 5:

In the case of Fierce Shoe, a simple and empathetic design can solve complex problems faced by customers. Fierce Shoe's virtual queue offers intentional scarcity, but this experience can feel outdated and stressful. The lean innovation and improvements proposal brings clarity, trust and joyful customer experience through a minimal but meaningful feature: a real-time visual queue showing approximate wait time and place in the line. The company will maintain the principle of scarcity but reframe it as care.

Lean innovation plan: Smart Queue UX/UI improvement for Fierce Shoe

Step	Description
Step 1: Identifying the process	The current virtual queue lacks visibility. Users have no idea of their place in line or how long they will wait, and that's creates frustration during product drops.
Step 2: Mapping out the desired state	The queue currently is a "blind wait" system. Customer enter and must wait with no real-time updates, status feedback, or estimated time. It's functional but emotionally cold.
Step 3: Defining the desired state	A new Smart Queue feature will show the customer's current position in line, estimated wait time, and progress - all wrapped in brand-aligned, calming messaging.
Step 4: Identifying improvement opportunities	By using lightweight design and development: simple front-end UX, polling or lightweight sockets, automated queue logic, and microcopy. The goal is not high tech - it's high clarity.
Step 5: Implementing the improvements	The plan and improvements will be executed over 8 weeks, with a cross-functional team of developers, designers and QA. A pilot can be runt on a smaller drop before scaling.

Step 6: Measuring and optimising	The company will track drop-off rate, user satisfaction feedback, and queue accuracy. Based on results, the team will fine-tune message timing, design language, and loyalty logic.
----------------------------------	---

Feature implementation time: 8 weeks is a reasonable and realistic timeframe for a Lean improvement plan, as it's not a full product rebuild - just a feature improvement, and the Fierce Shoe is a small to medium-sized business.

- **Goal:** transforming the current virtual queue into a clear, modern and user-friendly feature.
- **Feature:** Live Queue + Estimated Wait Time
 - position in line;
 - estimated wait time and stock access window;
 - customer information and respect during high-demand periods.

Plan

1. Discovery and planning:

Understanding current queue logic, gathering pain points and defining queue algorithm logic.

Time: 1 week

Team: 1 UX designer, 1 product owner, 1 front-end developer

2. UX Wireframe and microcopy:

Designing clean web/mobile-first visual UI (for example: "Est. 1 month", "You are #6 in line"), with a fusion of brand tone.

Time: 1 week

Team: 1 UX/UI designer

3. Development sprint:

Implementing real-time updates using polling or sockets (in case of need), testing dynamic load times.

Time: 2 weeks

Team: 1 front-end and 1 back-end developer

4. Internal testing:

Running a soft launch with staging users, as well as QA testing. Collecting micro-feedback.

Time: 1 week

Team: QA engineer, product owner

5. Live pilot during small drop:

Deploying the feature during a smaller launch and gathering data. Data and performance analysis.

Time: 1 week

Team: all stakeholders on standby

6. Feedback and adjustments:

Setting timing logic or UI based feedback. Adding personalisation (for example: “ You have shopped with us before”).

Time: 1 week

Team: all stakeholders on standby

7. Full launch:

Launching for a major seasonal drop and communicating via email/social media. Feedback review and analysis.

Time: 1 week

Team: marketing team, developers, community support

Benefits for Fierce Shoe after implementing Smart Queue UX/UI improvements:

- improves transparency and fairness during product drops;
- feels modern, organised and thoughtful;
- easier to track performance and to improve features in advance.

Fierce Shoe – Smart Queue Feature Launch Roadmap

Discovery and planning	Week 1-1								
UX Wireframe and microcopy	Week 2-2								
Development sprint	Week 3-4								
Internal testing	Week 5-5								
Live pilot during small drop	Week 6-6								
Feedback and adjustments	Week 7-7								
Full launch	Week 8-8								
Timeline	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Conclusions: in conditions of high demand, waiting is unavoidable, but how people wait is important. By clearly showing their place in the queue and waiting time, Fierce Shoe turns frustration into trust, as well as brand-aligned design makes scarcity feel customer-friendly, organised and not chaotic.

Bibliography

- <https://agilealliance.org/agile101/12-principles-behind-the-agile-manifesto/>
- <https://agilecoffee.com/toolkit/empathy-map/>
- <https://big-agile.com/blog/reach-impact-confidence-effort-rice>
- <https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/write-value-proposition>
- <https://ntegrity.com.au/blog/empathy-mapping/>
- <https://plaky.com/blog/rice-framework/>
- <https://vc.ru/marketing/274778-12-metodov-prioritizacii-produktovyh-celei-rice-wsjf-kano-i-prochie>
- <https://www.amper.co/post/lean-manufacturing-examples>
- <https://www.atlassian.com/agile/product-management/prioritization-framework>
- <https://www.atlassian.com/agile/project-management/lean-process-improvement>
- <https://www.deepl.com/en/translator>
- <https://www.forbes.com/sites/yec/2014/04/03/12-principles-for-leading-an-extraordinary-company/>
- <https://www.qmarkets.net/resources/article/lean-innovation-management/>
- <https://www.strategyzer.com/library/the-value-proposition-canvas>